

JON BAKER

Jon Baker Sets New Course Record

The 86 gross eclipses the previous Royal Óbidos best by a single shot, set across four TEG visits to the Óbidos coast.

At Royal Óbidos, Jon Baker carded a gross 86 in round three. The course record was 87, and it had survived 18 prior visits to the venue. It does not survive any longer. It was also his own best mark there, arriving eight shots inside what he had managed last time he stood on the first tee.

The round was built on the back nine, where Baker gathered 20 Stableford points across holes 11 to 16. He birdied the par-5 11th and the par-3 13th. Within that stretch he went four holes, 13 through 16, without dropping

a single gross shot. The lone blemish of the six-hole run was a bogey at the 12th, one of the harder holes on the course. Even the blemish had an alibi.

The round entrenched Baker's position in both of this year's TEG races. He already led the 2024 TEG Trophy, and pushed his advantage from 2 points to 11. In the Green Jacket race he moved past David Mullin, turning a share of the lead into an 8-point cushion heading into the next round.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY

Jon BAKER (44 pts)

TROPHY LEAD

Jon BAKER, 11 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD

Jon BAKER, 8 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD

JB 44 | JP 41 | DM 35 | AB 34 | GW 26

ROUND GROSS

JB +14 | DM +22 | JP +22 | GW +27 | AB +38

AFTER R3 · TROPHY

JB 126 | DM 115 | AB 103 | JP 102 | GW 94

AFTER R3 · GREEN JACKET

JB +48 | DM +56 | GW +64 | JP +89 | AB +112

DAVID MULLIN | JON BAKER

David Mullin's Jacket Lead Evaporates

David Mullin held the Green Jacket lead for barely five holes before Jon Baker's record-breaking round swept both races out of reach.

Jon Baker had led the 2024 TEG Green Jacket (Gross) for 35 holes, ever since the second hole of round one. A triple bogey at the first at Royal Óbidos handed it to David Mullin at the start of round three. The lead then changed three more times inside the round. Baker drew level with a bogey at the second, one of the hardest holes on the course, and went back in front at the fifth.

Mullin retook it with a par at the sixth, only for Baker to draw level with a bogey at the seventh and lead again at the eighth. Drawing level with bogeys is not glamorous. It is, however, permitted.

By the close of play Baker held the Jacket outright. He was helped considerably by Mullin's Stableford total falling from 47 points in round two to 35, a swing of 12. Baker also carded a course personal

best at Royal Óbidos, eight strokes better than his previous visit there.

The same round did the same work in the 2024 TEG Trophy. Baker's overnight lead of two points stretched to eleven as Mullin faded. Baker now commands both races heading into the back half of the tournament. Mullin has 35 holes of memories.

WOODEN SPOON

Williams Slips To The Bottom

A seven-hole run without a net par condemned Gregg Williams to last place just as John Patterson posted a personal best at Royal Óbidos to climb clear.

At Royal Óbidos, John Patterson followed a second round of 22 Stableford points with a 41. A swing of 19 points is not an improvement. It is a change of identity.

He began dreadfully. A double bogey at the 4th, a triple bogey at the 5th, then more doubles at the 6th and 7th. A birdie at the 8th stopped the bleeding. Thereafter he found his best form, going through the 12th and 13th without dropping a gross shot and piling up 13 points across holes 12 to 15. It amounted to his best gross score at the course this TEG.

Gregg Williams travelled in the opposite direction, and with more commitment. A quadruple bogey nine at the par-5 5th served as an early notice of intent. There was a brief recovery at the 11th, which in hindsight looks cruel. From the 12th he collapsed entirely: seven holes without a net par, 14 shots dropped across them. A double bogey at the 14th confirmed his descent to the bottom of the 2024 Wooden Spoon race. He and Patterson simply swapped places, Patterson having held that position before the round. One man was rescued. The other volunteered.

ALEX BAKER

Four Blow-Ups Undo Alex Baker

A sextuple-bogey ten at the 14th was merely the low point of a round that produced four separate blow-up holes for Alex Baker.

Alex Baker assembled the worst gross round in the field at Royal Óbidos. It was a card with double-figure damage at both ends and very little in between.

The trouble began early. A quadruple bogey 8 at the 4th, the hardest hole on the course, was followed immediately by a quadruple bogey 9 at the par-5 5th. Across holes 4 to 7 he bled 12 shots. He kept walking, unhurried, like a man being led from a building he had just set fire to.

Worse followed at the close. Across holes 12 to 16, Alex Baker shipped 15 shots, a stretch that included a sextuple bogey 10 at the 14th. That was the round's low point, and it took some finding. The 18th declined to offer sanctuary, yielding another quadruple bogey, a 9 on the par-5 closer.

The round finished well outside Alex Baker's own best figures at the course, and the round-of-the-day comparison recorded the field's worst gross score of the day at 38. It nevertheless counts as this TEG's best score so far at Royal Óbidos for Alex Baker. A floor, of sorts, given what it followed.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 17, Round 3

COURSE RECORDS

— Jon Baker's 86 at Royal Óbidos — a new course record, beating 87; 18 earlier rounds there